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PROSCI CATALYST REPORT

Research Insights for Change Success

The Human Side of AI

A Leader's Guide to Successful AI Adoption

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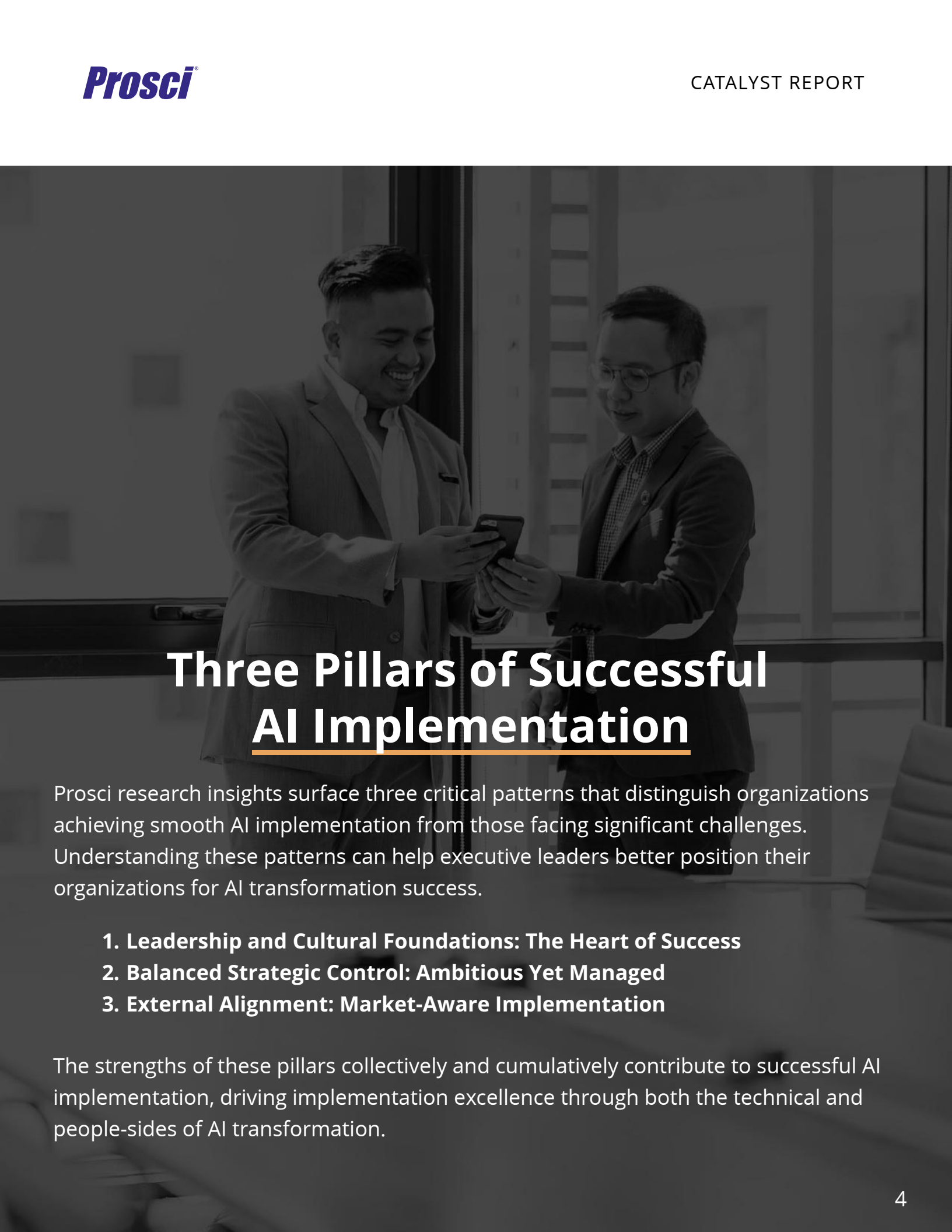
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Executive Summary

193 executives recently shared their experience steering AI implementation, revealing a striking insight: the difference between successful and struggling AI implementations is not about installing AI technology, but rather how organizations manage the human elements of change. This Prosci Catalyst Report synthesizes key findings that matter most to executive leaders driving AI transformation, offering practical insights for successful AI implementation. We are excited to share these findings with you and further explore what 'AI adoption done right' might look like for your organization.





Three Pillars of Successful AI Implementation

Prosci research insights surface three critical patterns that distinguish organizations achieving smooth AI implementation from those facing significant challenges. Understanding these patterns can help executive leaders better position their organizations for AI transformation success.

- 1. Leadership and Cultural Foundations: The Heart of Success**
- 2. Balanced Strategic Control: Ambitious Yet Managed**
- 3. External Alignment: Market-Aware Implementation**

The strengths of these pillars collectively and cumulatively contribute to successful AI implementation, driving implementation excellence through both the technical and people-sides of AI transformation.

1. Leadership and Cultural Foundations

The Heart of Success

Organizations achieving smooth AI implementation demonstrate exceptionally strong leadership commitment and an organizational culture that is ready for AI. Additionally, successful AI implementations show a higher commitment to a human-centric approach, using AI to augment human capabilities, rather than replace workers.



What sets organizations with successful AI implementations apart:

- They demonstrate strong leadership support for AI initiatives (+1.65 on a -2 to +2 scale, compared to -1.50 in struggling organizations)
- Their organizational culture actively supports AI-driven change (+1.60 on a -2 to +2 scale, compared to -1.00 in struggling organizations)
- They focus on using AI to augment rather than replace human capabilities (+1.42 on a -2 to +2 scale, with an overall average of +1.22 across all organizations)

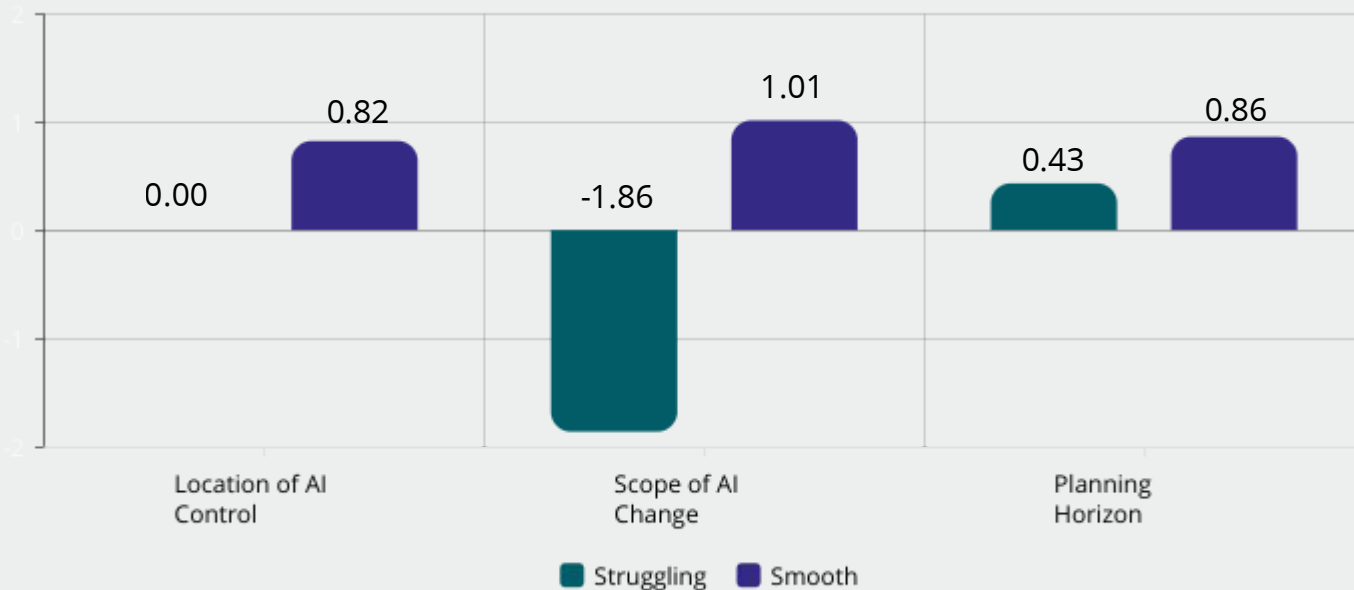
*"In over two decades of our research, the role of active and visible sponsorship has been identified as the top contributor to success. **While many aspects of the AI transformation look different than previous technologies, the critical role of leaders is constant.** Leaders must demonstrate their commitment, describe the future of their AI-enabled organization and AI-adept workforce, and actually use the tools!"*

Tim Creasey, Chief Innovation Officer, Prosci

2. Balanced Strategic Control

Ambitious Yet Managed

The research reveals a clear pattern in how successful organizations approach their AI implementation strategy. Specifically, organizations achieving smooth implementation combine strong centralized control (+0.82) with ambitious transformation goals (+1.01), and a longer-term focus (+0.86). In contrast, struggling organizations show no clear preference for centralized or decentralized management (0.00), strongly favor small, incremental changes (-1.86), and show more moderate long-term focus (+0.43). This dramatic contrast suggests that successful AI implementation requires both clear, centralized strategic direction and the courage to pursue transformational change.



3. External Alignment

Market-Aware Implementation

The research reveals clear patterns in how successful organizations align their AI initiatives with external factors. Organizations achieving smooth implementation demonstrate strong industry influence (+1.29) and competitive awareness (+1.11), while maintaining positive regulatory consideration (+0.49). In contrast, struggling organizations show minimal industry impact (-0.14), little competitive pressure (-1.17), and negative regulatory impact (-0.57). This striking difference highlights how successful organizations actively align their AI initiatives with market forces while effectively navigating regulatory requirements.

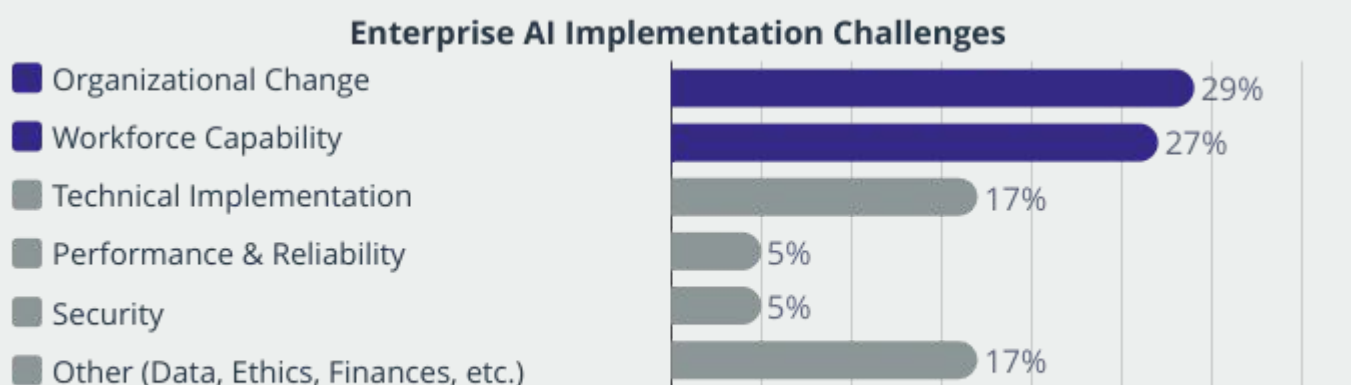


*"Unlike a typical system or technology rollout, using AI is often not seen as a 'required' aspect of one's job role. **Defining success at the onset of the rollout, aligning company goals with industry trends, and adapting change management actions to foster AI adoption will offer a clear competitive advantage** for individuals and organizations that embrace it."*

Brandon Richie, Advisory Engagement Leader, Prosci

The Critical Role of Change Management

The research highlights a crucial finding: while the technical implementation of AI is challenging (reported by 17% of executives), the biggest challenges to enterprise AI adoption ultimately depend on effectively managing the human side of change (Organizational Change and Workforce Capability, reported by 56%). Change management and workforce development emerge not as secondary considerations but as primary barriers to AI implementation success.



These findings show that the biggest challenge executives face in implementing AI isn't the technology; it's adoption and support of the workers who will use the technology. Helping workers through the AI adoption, and offering them the skills they need to successfully navigate change will position your AI transformation for greater success.

*"Prosci research shows that **AI won't transform your organization, but the people who use AI will.** That's why it matters to bring your people along in the transformation journey. Installing AI alone is not enough for impact; it has to be embraced, adopted, and used for leaders to realize the full ROI they expect from their AI investment."*

Scott Anderson, PhD, Sr. Principal of Research, Prosci

Moving Forward

The Path to Successful AI Implementation

The research shows that successful AI implementation requires a holistic approach that addresses both technical and human elements of change. To succeed, organizational leaders should focus on three key pillars of AI success, based on the research findings:



1. Build Strong Foundations

- Ensure strong leadership support
- Develop cultural readiness
- Maintain focus on human augmentation

2. Establish Balanced Control

- Implement centralized governance
- Set ambitious transformation goals
- Maintain long-term view



3. Maintain External Alignment

- Monitor industry influence
- Track competitive dynamics
- Address regulatory considerations



Final Thoughts

As an AI leader, you have the exciting opportunity to shape the future of your organization and unlock the vast potential of this game-changing technology. The key to success lies in recognizing and proactively addressing the human side of AI.

By leveraging the insights from this research - building strong leadership and organizational culture foundations, establishing balanced control, and maintaining external alignment - you can position your organization to not only navigate the challenges of AI, but to truly thrive in the age of artificial intelligence.

Prosci is here to support you every step of the way.

Partnering for Change Done Right The Prosci Advantage

This research underscores both the transformative potential of AI and the critical importance of navigating the human side of implementation to realize that potential. While many organizations provide change management as an add-on to their implementation, at Prosci, getting change done right is our purpose and passion. That's why Prosci is uniquely positioned to help you on this journey. As a global leader in change management, Prosci offers:

- Best practices and proven methodologies from years of research and experience
- Deep expertise in the people side of change and technology adoption
- Customized solutions to address your unique adoption goals and challenges
- A track record of driving successful transformation in organizations around the world

By partnering with Prosci, you gain access to the expert guidance and proven strategies needed to proactively address the human side of AI and position your organization for transformative success.

Are you ready to elevate your AI initiative, achieve game-changing AI adoption, and drive business outcomes that achieve your vision? Contact Prosci today to explore how our proven methodologies and expertise can empower your organization to realize the full value of AI.

To learn more, visit <https://www.prosci.com/ai-change-management> or email solutions@prosci.com to schedule a free consultation. Together, we can help you deliver AI transformation done right.

Have questions?
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